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Why Study French?

French Can Take You around the World!



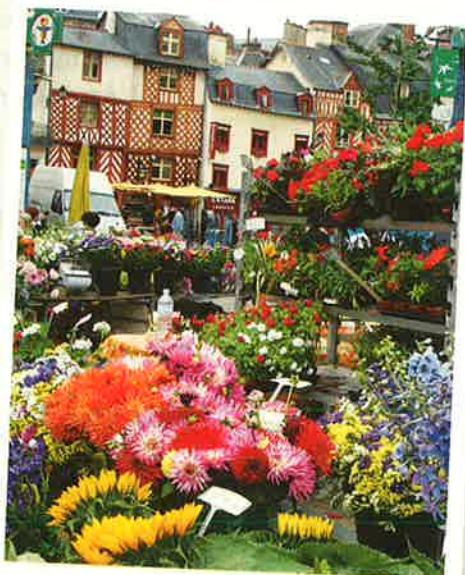
Margot M. Steinhart, Ph.D.

Chers élèves,

Formidable! You have chosen to learn French, the most frequently studied world language after English, and are becoming a citizen of the world. Your sphere immediately expands to include 175 million French speakers in more than 50 countries and millions of people who have studied French on five continents. And did you know that about 2 million people speak French as a first language in the U.S.?

In addition to learning the language, you will discover the uniqueness of many cultures from around the world. You will have the opportunity to explore Quebec, the Caribbean, West and North Africa, Europe, and the Pacific Ocean islands, to name a few. It is remarkable that through one language, French, the richness of these diverse regions can be learned and experienced. You can connect to the Francophone world through e-mail correspondence or by travel and study experiences.

Did you select French because it is a language associated with renowned artists, literary giants, medical, scientific, and technological break-through discoveries, and an enviable sense of style? French can also improve your English-language skills since French is more like English than is any other Romance language, such as Italian and Spanish. More than 30% of English vocabulary is derived from French. How many French expressions related to government, law, food, art, music, dance, cinema, literature,



Browse the flower market in Rennes. It's a visual delight!

Take the bullet train from Paris to Nice. It can be fun!



Buy souwèrè paintings by local artisans in markets all over Senegal.

